Story Writing Practice Bank

CBSE Grade 8 • Essential Prompts, Structure & Assessment Guidelines

25 Essential Topics for Practice

Category 1: Given Opening Lines (Prompts)

- **The Storm:** "It was a dark and stormy night. I was alone at home when suddenly the lights went out and I heard a knock..."
- **The Discovery:** "While cleaning the attic, I stumbled upon a dusty old box. When I opened it, I couldn't believe my eyes..."
- **The Strange Encounter:** "I was waiting for my school bus when a peculiar man in a long coat handed me an envelope and ran away..."
- **The Magic Door:** "I always thought the door at the end of the corridor was locked, until one day it slightly creaked open..."
- **Lost in the Woods:** "We strayed away from our camping group. As the sun began to set, the forest seemed to change..."

Category 2: Moral-Based Stories

- **Honesty is the Best Policy:** Write a story about a student who finds a lost wallet containing a large amount of money.
- **A Friend in Need is a Friend Indeed:** Create a tale of two friends whose bond is tested during a difficult situation.
- **Pride Goes Before a Fall:** Write a story about a talented but arrogant athlete who learns a lesson in humility.
- **Where There is a Will, There is a Way:** Tell the story of a visually impaired child who dreams of becoming a musician.
- **Greed Leads to Grief:** Write a story about a greedy merchant who loses everything in pursuit of more wealth.

Category 3: Mystery & Adventure

- **The Haunted House:** A group of friends decide to explore the abandoned mansion at the edge of the town on Halloween night.
- **The Treasure Hunt:** You find an ancient map hidden inside a library book that leads to a secret location in your city.
- **The Missing Diamond:** Write a detective story where you have to solve the mystery of a stolen necklace at a party.
- **The Stowaway:** A story about sneaking onto a ship for an adventure and discovering a dangerous secret.
- **The Secret Agent:** Imagine you are an undercover agent tasked with retrieving a stolen gadget from a villain's lair.

Category 4: Fantasy & Sci-Fi

- **The Time Machine:** You accidentally activate a machine that transports you 100 years into the future.
- **The Talking Animal:** Write a story about a stray dog you rescued who suddenly starts talking to you.
- **Alien Visit:** A spaceship lands in your school playground during the lunch break.
- **The Magic Paintbrush:** Whatever you draw with this brush comes to life. How do you use it?
- **Superpowers for a Day:** You wake up with the ability to read minds. Describe the chaos and fun of that day.

Category 5: Humorous & Real-Life Experiences

- **The Day Everything Went Wrong:** A comedy of errors where from morning to night, nothing goes according to plan.
- **A Hilarious Misunderstanding:** A story about confusing two people with the same name.
- **The Surprise Party:** Planning a secret birthday party for your mother that almost gets ruined.
- **The Cooking Disaster:** Trying to cook dinner for the family for the first time with comical results.
- **The Escaped Pet:** Trying to catch your mischievous pet parrot who escapes into the neighborhood.

Format & Marking Scheme (5 Marks)

Element	Marks	CBSE Requirements (120–150 Words)
Title	**1 Mark**	A catchy, relevant title that hints at the story's theme.
Content	**2 Marks**	Creative plot, character development, and a logical sequence of events (Beginning, Middle, End).
Expression	**2 Marks**	Grammatical accuracy (mostly past tense), vocabulary, coherence, and relevance to the prompt/moral.

Golden Rules for Story Writing

- **Stick to the Tense:** Stories are almost always written in the **Past Tense**. Keep it consistent unless using dialogue.
- **Build a Climax:** A good story has a problem or conflict that reaches a peak (the climax) before being resolved in the end.
- **Use Dialogues Wisely:** Include 1 or 2 short dialogues to make the characters feel alive, but don't overdo it.